

FESTIVAL

Right Moves

There is something about dance that echoes spontaneity. It is believed to be the hidden language of the soul, an expression of joy and total surrender to a loved one and God. In India, dance has evolved into various forms over the years. To mark the occasion of World Dance Day on April 29, Kri Foundation is presenting a five-day festival. On April 25, Bharatanatyam dancer Rama Vaidyanathan will present a special performance, *Dance of the Birds*, to draw attention to the issue of bird conservation. On April 28, watch *DanzLenz*, a series of short films on dance from India and abroad. Dancers rarely come together for a cause, but on April 29, the Dance Fraternity Day will feature Yamini Krishnamurthy, Uma Sharma, Madhvi Mudgal, Ranjana Gauhar, Singhajit Singh, Prathibha Prahlad, Prerana Shrimali, Geetanjali Lal, Kanaka Srinivasan, Geeta Chandran and others. At Habitat Centre.

The other festival has been organised by Natya Vriksha on May 2 and 3. On May 2, a seminar addressing the issue, *Strengthening our Global Footprint: Strategies for Indian Classical Dance*, will be anchored by dancer-choreographer Anita Ratnam. The speakers include dance critic Shanta Serbjeet Singh, dancer Jayant Kastuar and international festival director Sanjoy Roy. The festival opens with a Bharatanatyam performance by Ragini Chander Shekar, followed by a Kuchipudi recital by Arunima Kumar. On May 3, Jayaprabha Menon will present Mohiniattam and Vidha Lal's Kathak. At India International Centre.

"The future of dance is in the hands (in this case the feet) of the young," feels Kuchipudi dancer Raja Reddy. And to reaffirm his commitment to dance, he will have his students perform on stage on April 29 at The Epicentre, Gurgaon.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

STUDENTS OF
RAJA REDDY

DANCE

Not Just Looking



"There is no more difficult art to acquire than the art of observation, and for some men it is quite as difficult to record an observation in brief

and plain language," said physician William Osler. Sadly, in India there is no practice of keeping record of artistic journeys, trends and transition. So when one gets Ashish Mohan Khokar's *Attendance*, the dance annual of India 2008-09, it is more than an observation on dance. It is a document that goes beyond reviewing dance performances and festivals. This year it focuses on the gurus—Guru Gopinath, Mani Madhav Chakyar, M.K. Saroja, Kumudini Lakhia, Jayalakshmi Alva and others. It recalls their contribution to dance tradition. A ready reckoner for the young dancers who always revel in creating something new. Come take a peek at dance history.

THEATRE

Intimate Acts

In the days of big auditoriums and grand audiences, intimate theatre comes like a breath of fresh air for both performers and directors. Theatre at Home conceptualised by The Company Theatre in Mumbai has performed for several years for small audiences in homes. The city has also seen many performances directed by Rehaan Engineer of the Industrial Theatre Company giving superlative performances, catering to audiences ranging from 20 to 100 people with venues ranging from



A SCENE FROM 1, MADHAV BAGH

art galleries to restaurants to office complexes. Spreading the word about intimate theatre is Ranga Shankara in Bangalore with *1, Madhav Bagh*, written by the late Chetan Datar, is performed by Revathy Menon. The play marks the stage debut of Menon. Directed by Mariam Jetpurwala the play has been translated by Shanta Gokhale and will be performed across the country. From May 1 to 3 at Ranga Shankara.

by Nirmala Ravindran